

LUMP/SWELLING IN NECK, AXILLA OR GROIN

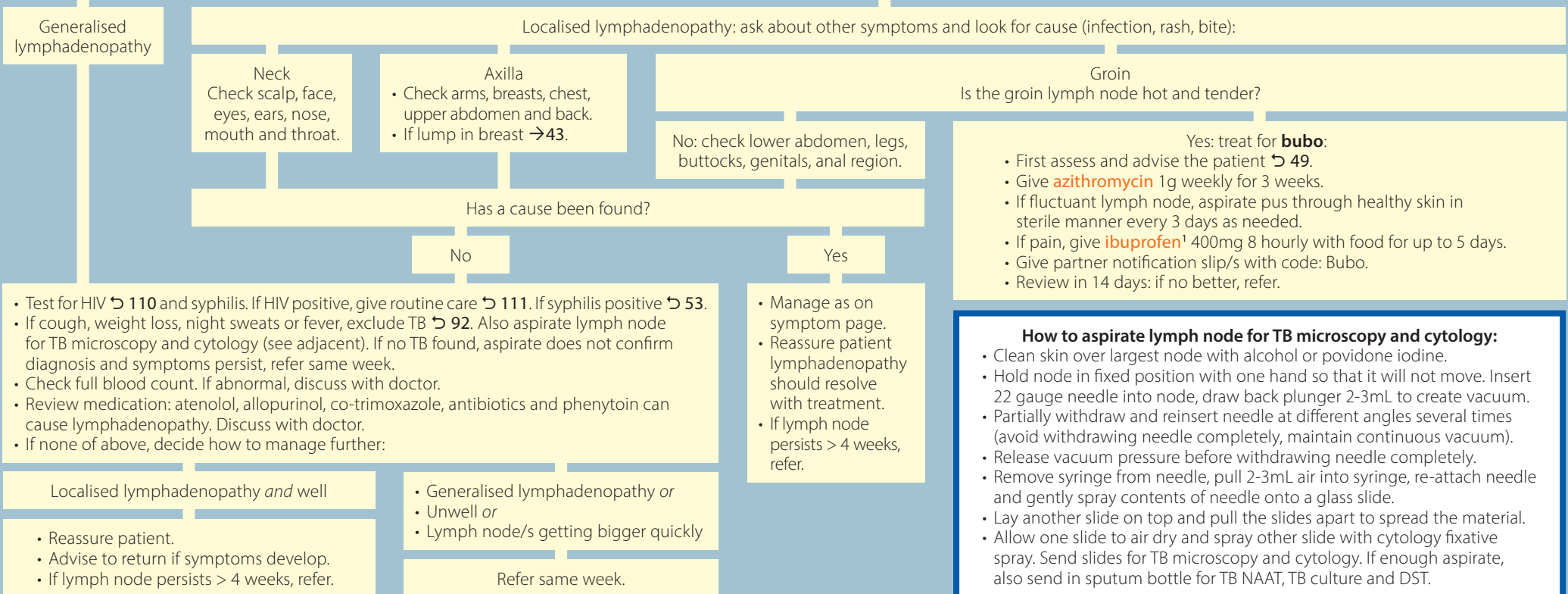
Give urgent attention to the patient with lump/swelling in groin and any of:

- Lump in groin that gets bigger when standing/coughing/passing stool and any of: severe pain, vomiting, no stools or flatus/wind for past 24 hours, or lump cannot be reduced: **incarcerated/strangulated inguinal hernia** likely
 - Pulsating lump: **aneurysm** likely
- Refer urgently.**

Approach to the patient with lump/swelling in neck, axilla or groin not needing urgent attention:

- If lump is in the skin → 67.
- If lump is beneath the skin, first exclude thyroid mass and hernia:
 - Lump in neck that moves up when patient swallows, **thyroid mass** likely: check TSH and refer same week for further investigation.
 - Lump in groin that gets bigger when standing/coughing/passing stool, **inguinal hernia** likely: refer.
- If none of the above, a lump in neck, axilla or groin is likely an enlarged lymph node (**lymphadenopathy**). If unsure, refer.

Is lymphadenopathy localised (neck or axilla or groin) or generalised (≥ 2 areas)?



How to aspirate lymph node for TB microscopy and cytology:

- Clean skin over largest node with alcohol or povidone iodine.
- Hold node in fixed position with one hand so that it will not move. Insert 22 gauge needle into node, draw back plunger 2-3mL to create vacuum.
- Partially withdraw and reinsert needle at different angles several times (avoid withdrawing needle completely, maintain continuous vacuum).
- Release vacuum pressure before withdrawing needle completely.
- Remove syringe from needle, pull 2-3mL air into syringe, re-attach needle and gently spray contents of needle onto a glass slide.
- Lay another slide on top and pull the slides apart to spread the material.
- Allow one slide to air dry and spray other slide with cytology fixative spray. Send slides for TB microscopy and cytology. If enough aspirate, also send in sputum bottle for TB NAAT, TB culture and DST.

¹Avoid ibuprofen if peptic ulcer, asthma, hypertension, heart failure, kidney disease.